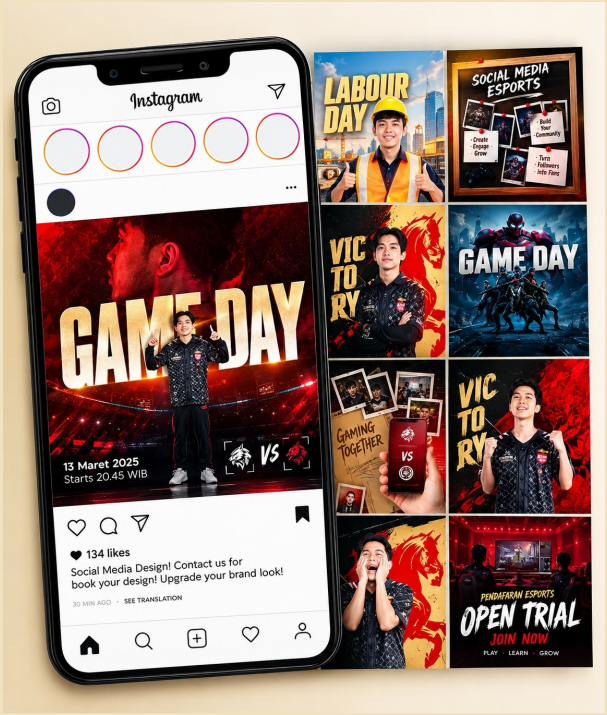
CASE STUDY | ESPORTS SOCIAL DESIGN

PENDEKAR ESPORTS

Instagram Carousel Series

Match days, victories, defeats and recruitment, designed as one bold and recognisable team identity.



ROLE
Social Media Designer

DELIVERABLE
12 slide post series

PLATFORM
Instagram feed

01 PROJECT OVERVIEW

A team identity built for the feed

Pendekar Esports is a competitive gaming team that needs to announce matches, celebrate wins, own its losses with honesty and recruit new players, all through Instagram. The brief was to design a carousel series that feels as intense as a match day and still stays consistent enough that followers recognise the team at a glance.

Client	Pendekar Esports
Project	Instagram carousel series for match days, results, community and recruitment
Format	Portrait and square feed posts, built to read on a phone screen
Language	English headlines with Bahasa Indonesia for local calls to action
Role	Concept, layout system, retouching, composition and final design

Skills used

Art direction	Defining a dark, high contrast look that fits esports culture.
Typography	Bold display lettering with texture, stacked and split words for impact.
Photo composition	Cutting players into stylised scenes, arenas and jungle battlefields.
Layout systems	Reusable templates so every new post can be produced quickly.
Storytelling	Using colour and pose to carry emotion: pride, joy, pain and hype.

Deliverables

- 12 carousel slides covering Game Day, Victory, Defeat, Upcoming Match, Schedule and Open Trial.
- A Labour Day greeting post in the same brand style.
- An Instagram feed mockup that shows the post in context with caption and engagement.
- A repeatable template kit for future match announcements and results.

02 THE CHALLENGE

Make a small team look big, and keep it consistent

Esports pages post often and on tight schedules. Without a system, the feed turns into a mix of unrelated graphics. The series had to look premium, flex across very different moods and still be fast to produce.

Key problems

- **Mood range.** One team has to express hype, pride, heartbreak and community without breaking the brand.
- **Speed.** Match announcements happen on short notice, so layouts must be quick to reuse.
- **Recognition.** Followers should know it is Pendekar before they read a single word.
- **Recruitment.** Open Trial posts must feel as exciting as match posts to attract new players.

Goals

Identity	Lock a red, black and gold look with a signature horse emblem.
Engagement	Give followers a reason to stop on every post type, from results to recruitment.
Efficiency	Create templates that support quick turnaround on match days.
Growth	Turn the page into a recruiting channel with clear Open Trial calls to action.

Audience

- Current fans who follow every match and want quick, exciting updates.
- Aspiring players looking for a team and a path to compete.
- Local community members and sponsors who judge the team by how it presents itself.

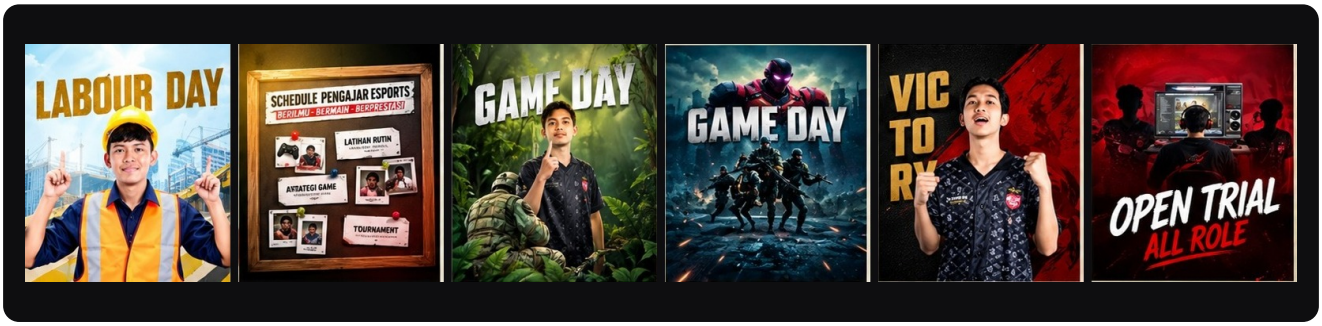
One emotion per post type

Each content type owns a mood and a layout. That keeps the feed varied but predictable, so people learn what each kind of post means before they read it.

Post type	Mood and treatment	Purpose
Game Day	Hype and anticipation. Epic scenes: cyber battlefield, jungle, sunset field and arena lights, with huge metallic lettering.	Match announcements
Victory	Pride and celebration. Gold stacked lettering, a charging red horse and the player in a confident or joyful pose.	Win results
Defeat	Honest disappointment. The same system as Victory, but the pose and mood turn, which keeps the team human.	Loss results
Upcoming Match	Anticipation. Polaroid photos, a phone showing the versus screen and warm paper textures.	Fixtures
Schedule	Order and routine. A wooden pinboard of notes for training, strategy and tournaments.	Programs and training
Open Trial	Opportunity. A dark gaming room with bold white and red type and a clear call to join.	Recruitment

Why this works

- Victory and Defeat share the same layout, so results are instantly recognisable and the emotion is carried by the pose alone.
- Game Day posts use cinematic backgrounds, which makes match announcements feel like movie posters.
- Recruitment posts reuse the team colours, so new players meet the same identity as fans.



04 VISUAL IDENTITY

Dark, loud and instantly recognisable

Arena Black
#0E0E10
Backgrounds, jerseys, depth

Pendekar Red
#D7191F
Energy, brush strokes, accents

Victory Gold
#E8B84A
Headlines and key words

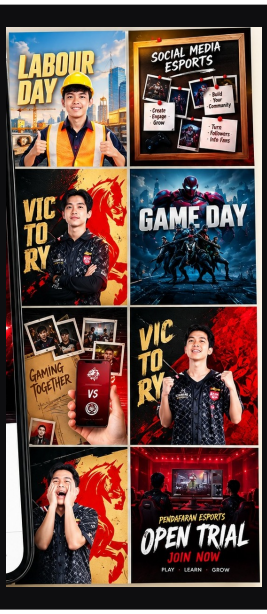
Paper Cream
#F6EBD3
Pinboards, notes, texture

Typography

Heavy condensed display type does the shouting. Gold gradients and metal textures give Game Day and Victory headlines a trophy feel, while rough brush strokes in white and red add speed and attitude to Open Trial. Words are stacked and split into syllables (VIC TO RY, DE FE AT) so they fill tall portrait frames and read from a distance.

Design components

Horse emblem	A red brush stroke horse behind the player is the recurring brand mark on result posts.
Player jersey	The black patterned jersey with the team crest keeps every portrait on brand.
Textures	Grunge, scratches, glow and paper grain add the feel of a printed match poster.
Props	Polaroids, pins, a smartphone and earphones bring in community and everyday gaming life.
Lighting	Red rim light and warm gold highlights separate the player from dark backgrounds.



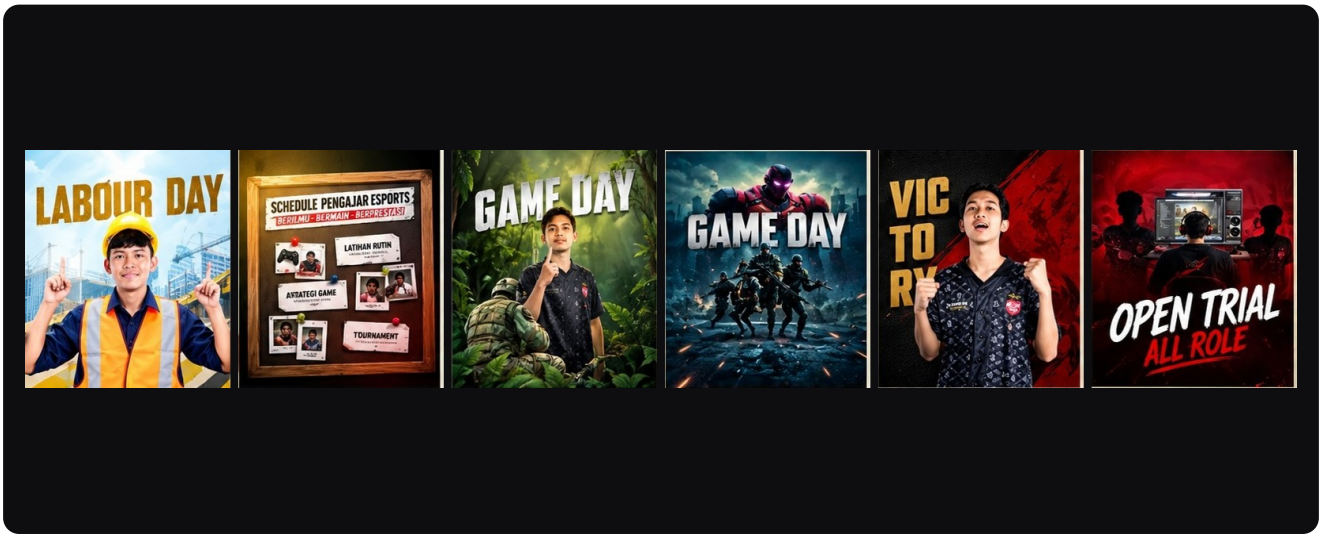
05 TEMPLATE SYSTEM

Six layouts power the whole series

Template	Structure	Used on
A. Hero portrait	Giant headline behind or beside a cut out player. Used for Victory and Defeat.	Victory, Defeat
B. Cinematic scene	Full bleed environment with the headline centred or on top.	Game Day
C. Player and prop	Close portrait with a prop in hand, such as cards or a phone.	Game Day, Upcoming Match
D. Collage board	Polaroids and paper on a textured surface for community moments.	Upcoming Match
E. Pinboard	Wooden board with pinned notes to list programs and schedules.	Schedule
F. Call to action	Dark scene, bold type and a clear Join Now line.	Open Trial

Consistency rules

- Headlines stay inside safe margins so nothing is cropped in the grid view.
- Gold is reserved for the main word, red for accents, white for supporting copy.
- The player always keeps strong contrast against the background, even in busy scenes.
- Textures stay subtle behind faces so expressions remain the focus.



06 SLIDE BREAKDOWN

What each post does

Post	Role in the story
01 Labour Day	A bright, friendly greeting with a hard hat and safety vest. It shows the brand can step outside match content.
02 Schedule Pengajar Esports	A pinboard of training, strategy and tournament notes. It frames the team as a structured program.
03 Game Day (Jungle)	A player in a dense jungle with a soldier beside him. It brings battle royale atmosphere to the feed.
04 Victory	Arms crossed, stacked gold headline and the red horse. A calm, confident win.
05 Game Day (Cyber)	A giant armoured hero over a ruined city. Pure hype for big matches.
06 Victory	Hands pressed together in a respectful pose. A humble win.
07 Upcoming Match	Polaroids, earphones and a phone with the versus screen. A warm announcement of the next fixture.
08 Victory	Fists raised and an open mouth cheer. High energy celebration.
09 Game Day (Cards)	Close portrait holding game cards. A playful, personal match day teaser.
10 Defeat	Hands on face on the same horse layout. Honest and relatable.
11 Open Trial All Role	A dark gaming room with silhouettes at screens. A clear invitation to join.
12 Game Day (Sunset)	The team lined up on a field at golden hour. A sense of unity before the match.

07 IN CONTEXT

How it looks in the feed

A phone mockup shows a Game Day post for 13 Maret 2025 at 20.45 WIB, with the team logos in a versus lockup, the date and time in the corner and a short caption about design services. Seeing the post beside the grid proves that the series works both as a single post and as a full profile.



What to notice

- The headline stays legible at phone size even with the player overlapping the lettering.
- Date and time sit in a quiet corner so the main message stays clean.
- The red and gold palette makes the post stand out in a feed full of lighter content.

08 OUTCOME AND TAKEAWAYS

What the project shows

- **One system, many moods.** Six templates cover hype, pride, disappointment, community and recruitment.
- **Emotion through design.** Pose, colour and type change the mood without changing the brand.
- **Speed with quality.** Reusable layouts support quick production on match days.
- **Recognition.** Red, black and gold plus the horse emblem make the team identifiable even in a small thumbnail.

Project snapshot

Format	Instagram carousel posts
System	Six reusable templates
Content themes	Hype, pride, disappointment, community and recruitment
Designer's note	"One identity should carry every win, loss and big moment."

Design note by Tomisin, the designer of this project.

Tools

Design: Canva, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Figma and Adobe Express.
Content: CapCut, Meta Business Suite, Pinterest, plus Freepik or Envato for stock assets.

Need a team identity that wins the feed?
Social media design, carousels and brand led content.